YOUSIF ZUHAIR YOUSIF

IT Analyst | Cybersecurity, Systems Administration and Networking
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Professional Summary

Cybersecurity-focused IT professional with hands-on experience deploying and managing Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Privileged Access Management (PAM), and firewall solutions across enterprise environments. Skilled in virtualization, systems administration (Windows and Linux), IT asset management, and incident response, with a background in software development spanning multiple languages and frameworks. Certified in CompTIA Security+, Fortinet, and INE Enterprise Defense Administrator (eEDA).

Key Skills

SIEM Administration | Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) | Privileged Access Management (PAM) | Firewall Management | Network Security | Incident Response | Vulnerability Management | Systems Administration (Windows/Linux) | Virtualization | Active Directory | IT Asset Management | Security Policy and Compliance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Analyst, Kurdistan Region Government – Prime Minister Office, *Iraq, Erbil* | June 2025 - Current

Manage network security, endpoint protection, and infrastructure operations for a government office environment. Own firewall administration, virtualization, asset management, and device provisioning end to end.

- Identified a VPN security gap and led remediation through organization-wide Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enforcement, strengthening perimeter access controls.
- Managed and monitored FortiGate firewall operations, ensuring secure network connectivity and perimeter defense.
- Deployed and administered UniFi Network Controller on a local server, centralizing management of access points and switches to improve network performance and reliability.
- Configured FortiGate firewalls for the Runaki project, establishing site-to-site VPN tunnels, firewall policies, and VPN user accounts to enable secure inter-site connectivity.
- Deployed Kaspersky Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and antivirus via Kaspersky Security Center, expanding endpoint security coverage through policy configuration and continuous monitoring.
- Built a Windows 11 golden-image deployment system (DISM, WinPE, Sysprep), capturing a WIM to external SSD and deploying via USB for rapid, consistent device provisioning.
- Enrolled and managed organizational devices in Microsoft Intune, enforcing security policies through centralized device management.
- Implemented and maintained Snipe-IT for IT asset management, ensuring accurate hardware tracking and lifecycle reporting.
- Installed and maintained Proxmox virtualization environments for Windows and Linux virtual machines for production and testing.
- Provided onsite and remote technical support across departments, resolving hardware and software issues on Windows and macOS systems.

Information Security Analyst, Nass E-payment, *Iraq, Erbil* | July 2024 – June 2025

Owned security monitoring, privileged access, and endpoint protection across the organization's payment infrastructure. Combined hands-on tool deployment with policy and documentation work to mature the security program.

- Deployed and managed enterprise Privileged Access Management (PAM) solutions, Delinea Secret Server and Mamori M4PAM, securing privileged access across multiple sites.
- Implemented and configured Wazuh SIEM (Security Information and Event Management) for log monitoring and incident response, then delivered training to the Security Operations Center (SOC) team to operationalize it.
- Managed Trend Micro Vision One antivirus agents, configuring security policies and Data Loss Prevention (DLP) rules; deployed ClamAV on Windows and Linux servers for additional malware protection.
- Monitored and analyzed firewall logs from SFMC, strengthening perimeter defense and threat detection.

- Enhanced the Information Security Policy to align with industry best practices and regulatory standards.
- Led requirements gathering and deployment for an organization-wide IT asset inventory system, improving tracking and reporting.
- Produced documentation for change management, incident response, auditing, and security reviews.

Software Development Intern, Shift Software, *Iraq, Erbil* | August 2024 – October 2024

Gained hands-on full-stack development experience as an intern, working across frontend and backend technologies while learning software engineering practices from the team.

- Built a documentation site (Markdown, HTML, CSS) and an interactive Tic-Tac-Toe web application (HTML, CSS, JavaScript).
- Designed and implemented a to-do list application using C# Blazor and Microsoft SQL Server, covering both frontend and backend.
- Collaborated with the development team on project planning, implementation, and code reviews, ensuring code quality through testing and debugging.

Education

Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Engineering, University of Kurdistan Hewlêr, Erbil, Iraq
Final Project: Autonomous Self-Parking Car using Arduino microcontroller

CERTIFICATIONS

Enterprise Defense Administrator (eEDA), INE | June 2026

McKinsey's Forward Program, McKinsey | July 2025

Security+, CompTIA | March 2025

Fortinet Certified Associate, Fortinet | March 2025

IT Support Professional Specialization Certificate, Google | November 2024
Included courses : Technical Support Fundamentals,The Bits and Bytes of Computer Networking, Operating Systems and You: Becoming a Power User, System Administration and IT Infrastructure Services, IT Security: Defense against the Digital Dark

Pearson Test of English (PTE): Score 86 of 90

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Cybersecurity and Security Tools:** Wazuh SIEM, Delinea Secret Server, Mamori M4PAM, Kaspersky EDR, Kaspersky Security Center, ClamAV, Trend Micro Vision One, FortiGate Firewall, Kali Linux, Incident Response, Security Monitoring, Threat Detection, Data Loss Prevention (DLP), Security Policy Development
- **System Administration:** Windows Server, Linux Server, VMware ESXi, Proxmox, Microsoft Intune, Active Directory, Group Policy, Digital Forensics, Virtualization, System Monitoring
- **Networking:** UniFi Network Controller, Firewalls, VPN, Network Security, TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, Wireshark, Routing and Switching
- **Programming and Development:** Python, C++, Java, C#, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, SQL, Git, Blazor, Node.js, Express.js, Bootstrap, REST APIs, Agile Methodology
- **Database Management:** MySQL, Microsoft SQL Server, SQL Server Management Studio.
- **IT Management and Productivity:** Snipe-IT, Microsoft 365, Google Workspace, Technical Documentation, Change Management
- **Hardware and Embedded Systems:** Arduino, Circuit Design, DesignSoft TINA

LANGUAGES

Sureth (Chaldean Neo-Aramaic): Native | English: Fluent | Arabic: Fluent | Kurdish: Very Good